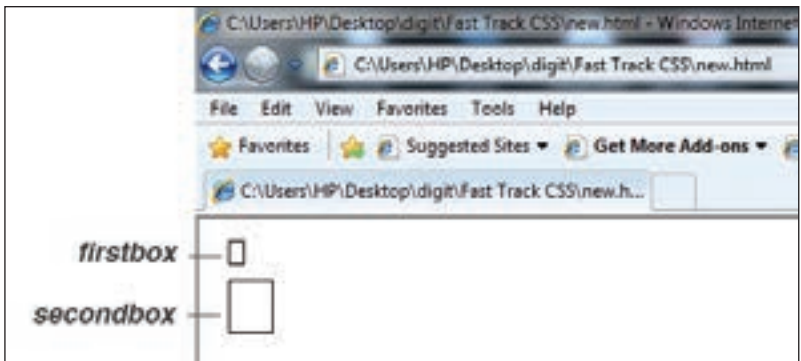


when the end user's viewing device and text preferences are unpredictable. The origin of the word itself is unconventional. It stems from the typography industry roughly equaling the size of an uppercase letter M, hence it is pronounced "emm." However, in reality an em is actually larger than that. Because some fonts don't even have an M in them, the term has come to mean the height of the given font.

The em CSS measurement can be employed to define the lengths of almost any CSS property. This makes it especially powerful when applied to fonts and their containing elements. The user can resize the text using his browser tools, and the containing element defined in ems scales with it.

To illustrate this say within a given element, the font-size is set to 11 pixels. Then one em is equal to 11 pixels. If the font-size of another element is 30 pixels, one em in that element is equal to 30 pixels. If two rules for basic containers are identical except for the font-size, which is 11px and 30px, respectively. Both rules are given a width and height of 1em.

```
/* First container for the em example */
#firstbox {
margin:10px;
font-size:11px;
width:1em;
height:1em;
border:1px solid black;
}
```



The two containers will be of different sizes when viewed in the browser